

ABC SCHOOL
Sample Educational Institution

Attendance Policy

Standards for Student Attendance and Punctuality

Academic Year: 2025-2026

Edition: Sample Edition

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1. Purpose

Regular attendance is closely linked to academic achievement and social development. This policy establishes consistent expectations for attendance and punctuality for all students enrolled at ABC School, and describes the procedures followed by the school office and class teachers in recording, monitoring, and following up on absences.

Parents and guardians share responsibility with the school for ensuring that students attend regularly and arrive on time, except in cases of illness or other legitimate need for absence.

2. School Hours

Level	Start Time	End Time	Half-Day Dismissal
Pre-Kindergarten / Kindergarten	8:00 AM	12:30 PM	11:00 AM
Primary (Grades 1-5)	7:45 AM	2:15 PM	11:30 AM
Middle School (Grades 6-8)	7:45 AM	2:45 PM	11:30 AM

Gates open 15 minutes before the start time for each level. Students arriving after the start time are recorded as late and must sign in at the front office before proceeding to class.

3. Daily Attendance Procedure

- Class teachers record attendance within the first ten minutes of the first period each day.
- Attendance is recorded again after the lunch break for Primary and Middle School students.
- Any student marked absent without prior notice from a parent is followed up by the office via the contact method on file by midday.
- Attendance records are retained in the student's file for the duration of enrollment and for a reasonable period thereafter.

4. Categories of Absence

Category	Description	Documentation Required
Excused - Medical	Illness or medical appointment.	Parent note or medical certificate for 3+ consecutive days.
Excused - Family Emergency	Bereavement or urgent family matter.	Parent notification within 48 hours.
Excused - Approved Leave	Pre-approved travel or planned absence.	Leave of Absence form submitted 2 weeks in advance.
Unexcused	Absence without notice or valid reason.	None provided; recorded as unexcused.
School-Related	Field trips, competitions, school-sanctioned events.	Recorded automatically; no parent action required.

5. Late Arrival and Early Departure

Punctuality is taken seriously as it affects both the late student and the flow of the classroom for other students. The following thresholds apply across all grade levels.

- 1st-3rd late arrival in a term: recorded; a reminder notice is sent home.
- 4th-6th late arrival in a term: parent meeting requested with the Grade Coordinator.
- 7th or more late arrivals in a term: referred to the Vice Principal for a formal attendance plan.
- Early departures require a written request submitted at least one day in advance, except in emergencies.

6. Minimum Attendance Requirement

Students are expected to maintain a minimum overall attendance rate of 90% across each academic term, excluding school-related absences such as field trips or representing the school in competitions.

Attendance below this threshold may affect a student's eligibility for promotion, certain extracurricular privileges, or end-of-term recognition.

Attendance Rate	Status	Action
95% - 100%	Excellent	No action; eligible for attendance recognition award.
90% - 94.9%	Satisfactory	Monitored; no formal action required.
80% - 89.9%	At Risk	Parent meeting scheduled; attendance improvement plan offered.
Below 80%	Critical	Formal review by Grade Coordinator and Vice Principal; may affect promotion.

7. Leave of Absence Requests

Parents planning a known absence of two or more consecutive school days, such as for family travel, must submit a Leave of Absence Request Form at least two weeks prior to the planned absence. The form is available from the front office or the relevant Grade Coordinator.

Approval of leave is at the discretion of the Grade Coordinator and takes into account the timing of assessments and key learning activities. Teachers are not obligated to provide advance coursework for planned absences but will support the student's reintegration upon return.

8. Medical Absences

For illness lasting one to two days, a written note from a parent or guardian is sufficient. For illness extending three or more consecutive school days, a certificate from a medical practitioner is required upon the student's return. Students recovering from a contagious illness should not return to school until cleared, in line with general public health guidance communicated by the school nurse's office.

Students with a chronic medical condition requiring frequent absence should have an individualized health plan on file with the school nurse, developed in consultation with the family and, where appropriate, the student's physician.

9. Consequences of Chronic Absenteeism

Chronic absenteeism, defined as missing 20% or more of scheduled school days within a term regardless of reason, triggers a structured response intended to support the student and family rather than to penalize them.

- Initial conversation between the class teacher and parent to understand underlying causes.
- Development of a written attendance improvement plan with specific, measurable goals.
- Where absenteeism continues despite support, referral to the Vice Principal for a formal review, which may include reconsideration of continued enrollment.

10. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Parent/Guardian	Notify the school promptly of any absence and provide required documentation.
Class Teacher	Record daily attendance accurately and flag patterns of concern.
Grade Coordinator	Review attendance trends and meet with families as needed.
School Nurse	Maintain health-related absence documentation and advise on medical absences.
Vice Principal	Oversee formal attendance reviews and improvement plans.